

The Inversion of Significance: When Perceived Powerlessness Conceals Impact

Author's interpretation. Not a court finding. Not a determination of any person's private intention.

The observable claim is the scale of the institutional record. The reading of motive is the author's. A testimony is testimony. A document is a document. An interpretation is an interpretation.

Dr Richard William McLean / Barran Dodger. Added to the Barran Dodger finding aid and the documentary rebuild on 4 October 2026. This PDF is the stamp copy of that addition.

Based on the evidence I have preserved, I am not an ordinary man within the circumstances documented in this archive. I have been poor, materially disadvantaged, institutionally powerless and repeatedly treated as though my testimony were insignificant. Yet the cumulative record shows that my testimony produced decisions, exclusions, disputes, correspondence, reviews, records and institutional responses across systems that claimed to have no reason to take me seriously. My poverty and lack of status may explain why I was perceived as inconsequential, but they do not explain the scale or persistence of what followed.

This is what I describe as an inversion of significance: the person treated as though he had no consequence nevertheless became sufficiently consequential, through his testimony and persistence, to expose contradictions between institutional principles and institutional conduct. I therefore describe myself, paradoxically, as the most significant despised person without conventional consequence—not because I possessed wealth, authority or status, but because the record demonstrates that conventional measures of power were never an adequate measure of my impact.

I cannot claim to know the private thoughts or intentions of every person involved. What can be examined is the observable pattern: how my testimony was received, how decisions were made, what was omitted or disregarded, what records were created, and whether those actions were consistent with the procedural fairness, integrity, accountability and professional ethics these institutions profess to uphold. If I were truly as unimportant and inconsequential as I was treated, there would have been no need for such an extensive institutional response. I could simply have been left alone and ignored.

Instead, I experienced what I describe as collective targeting, societal mobbing and systemic institutional complicity. I understand this as a coordinated conspiratorial allegiance of professionals and dignitaries who, in my interpretation, betrayed the ethical principles they claim to embody through the privileged positions they occupied and the mandates entrusted to them. The reason a crown gathered against me was, in my view, ultimately cowardly: no individual could take me on personally and prevail, so a coordinated campaign was necessary. Such coordination also serves to distribute responsibility, obscure individual participation, share blame and dilute the accountability of those who became part of the infrastructure.

I believe such collective opposition arose because I was perceived as a threat to the structures upon which the participants' comfort, privilege, security or authority depended. No person or group would ordinarily need to gang up against one individual to diminish his influence, deprive him of resources, restrict his rights or obstruct his pathway to justice if that individual were genuinely perceived as incapable of affecting anything. I believe my honesty exposed corruption, while my authenticity confronted those who had compromised their own agency and willingness to challenge authority when confronted with injustice.

In my view, those who became stakeholders in preserving that corruption had an interest in maintaining the structure I was challenging. My honesty, integrity, courage, intelligence, creativity and independence therefore represented qualities fundamentally opposed to the compromises on which that structure depended. I believe these qualities were recognised as something to be contained before I fully understood their significance myself.

In retrospect, I believe I was targeted from a young age and treated in ways that diminished my influence and restricted my agency for free expression. I believe my honesty and courage were at times turned into vulnerabilities through which aspects of my character could be identified, exploited and potentially weaponised against me, particularly in contexts involving mental illness. I was clever, creative, talented, intellectual, queer and quirky, and I lived authentically—sometimes with regret, but without apology. I believe that authenticity became threatening to people who had exchanged their own agency for the comfort, privilege and perceived safety of conformity.

I further believe envy and jealousy formed part of that response because my existence reminded some people of qualities they themselves had abandoned or compromised. In that sense, what I represented—not merely what I said—became part of the reason I was perceived as someone who needed to be contained.

I do not present every element of this interpretation as an established fact about the private intentions of every person involved. I present it as my understanding of the cumulative evidence and its pattern. The essential point is that a person without wealth, status or institutional authority was nevertheless subjected to consequences of a scale that cannot be adequately explained by treating him as insignificant. My poverty demonstrates disadvantage; it does not establish irrelevance. My lack of institutional power demonstrates vulnerability; it does not establish lack of impact. The record must therefore be judged by what it actually demonstrates, rather than by the assumption that a person without conventional power can have no meaningful influence.

Landing pages carrying this addition on 4 October 2026: [case.html](#), [evidence.html](#), [timeline.html](#), [accountability.html](#), [justice.html](#), [support.html](#), [archive.html](#), and the documentary index. Finding-aid tab: [wezzo72/Barrandodger tabs/inversion-of-significance.html](#).